



Image of a high school skating team

While most people are sleeping in their cozy beds, I am skating in a cold skating rink: the skating club of boston.

In the morning I wake up at about 4:30 to get myself ready for my early morning skating, school, and sometimes even after school activities. In the mornings, it is always difficult to wake up, but the day has only just begun. After I'm ready for the day, I usually leave the house at 5:00 am to make it to my skating rink in Norwood by 5:30.

Once I get to the skating rink, I generally warm up off the ice from 5:30-5:50 am and skate from 6:00 am to about 8:00 or 10:00 am. Most of the time is spent on the ice, but some time is spent off of the ice. This includes additional off-ice training like ballet, ballroom, and free weights. Then after every training session, I must stretch for at least a few minutes so that I can train just as effectively the next day.

Due to school starting at 8:20, I always miss at least some of the first period if not the first two periods, which means that I have to learn all of the material for those first two periods on my own. This means that I also have additional teachers meetings which I have to arrange.

On top of missing school, I am also already exhausted by the time I get to school because I have been skating for at least 2 -4 hours per week. So almost everyday after school I finish my homework as soon as possible, and then, I go to sleep.

Being a student athlete is more than just a daily routine. There are countless events and extra training times that I must go to. For example, I've traveled to Michigan, California, Georgia, etc. In short, there is a lot of exhausting travel involved to go to various competitions and camps.

Although most people in figure skating go to a school, most competitive skaters attend an online high school. This allows many competitors to train 4-6 hours per day. By nature of attending an in-person school, it already restricts my skating time a lot, making it hard to even compete. So, it is an imperative to make the most of the time I have.